

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE AMENDMENT
TO
2 ENGROSSED SENATE BILL NO. 650 By: Paxton of the Senate
3 and
4 Harris of the House
5

6 An Act relating to public utilities; defining term;
7 requiring the governing body of a public utility to
8 adopt a plan for components of maintenance and
9 operation of public utilities; providing for contents
10 of plan; specifying process for notice; allowing for
11 public utilities to be in compliance upon approval of
12 plan; authorizing certain state agencies to verify
13 certain provisions of plan; preventing certain
14 recovery of damages under certain circumstances;
15 amending 51 O.S. 2021, Sections 152, as last amended
16 by Section 111, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024, 154, and
17 155, as amended by Section 21, Chapter 228, O.S.L.
2022 (51 O.S. Supp. 2024, Sections 152 and 155),
which relate to The Governmental Tort Claims Act;
defining term; increasing award amounts for certain
claims; specifying certain accidents and occurrences;
providing for the process and amounts awarded under
certain circumstances; expanding exemptions for
liability by the state or political subdivisions;
updating statutory references and language; making
language gender neutral; providing for codification;
and providing an effective date.

18 AUTHOR: Remove Representative Harris as principal House author and
19 substitute with Representative Duel.

20 AUTHORS: Add the following House Coauthors: Waldron and Harris

21 AMENDMENT NO. 1. Strike the title, enacting clause, and entire bill
22 and insert:

23 "An Act relating to public finance; requiring cabinet
24 secretary approval for salary increases in excess of
specified percentage; imposing limitation on maximum

1 salary increases; requiring agencies to adopt rules
2 related to job performance; excluding certain
3 licensed professional persons from certain
4 restrictions; providing for applicability to certain
5 employee category; providing for inapplicability to
6 non-appropriated agencies; providing for
7 inapplicability to certain employee categories;
8 providing for codification; providing an effective
9 date; and declaring an emergency.

10 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

11 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
12 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 280.1 of Title 62, unless there
13 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

14 A. No executive branch agency shall increase the salary of a
15 state employee by more than ten percent (10%) with respect to any
16 fiscal year unless the cabinet secretary with jurisdiction over the
17 agency formally approves such increase. The Office of Management
18 and Enterprise Services shall prescribe a form to be used by a
19 cabinet secretary and at least one copy of the approval shall be
20 retained by the agency providing the salary increase and one copy
21 shall be retained by the Office of Management and Enterprise
22 Services.

23 B. The maximum bonus amount that any state agency may provide
24 any state employee shall be ten percent (10%) of the base salary
amount in effect for the employee as of the original hire date for
the employee or as of the anniversary of such original hire date for

1 an employee with service in excess of one (1) fiscal year. The
2 Office of Management and Enterprise Services shall prescribe a form
3 to be used by executive branch agencies for the approval of a bonus
4 amount authorized by this subsection.

5 C. Each state agency shall establish, pursuant to permanent
6 administrative rules, a maximum authorized bonus amount for each
7 employee position within the agency and shall also establish metrics
8 or other performance measures with respect to each such employee
9 position or job category which shall either already be in effect as
10 of the date the bonus becomes effective or which shall take effect
11 not later than thirty (30) days after the employee is hired.

12 D. Salary adjustments for all employees performing services for
13 an executive branch agency in excess of ten percent (10%) may be
14 authorized as a result of performance reviews, a change in job
15 duties or titles or based on substantial modification of existing
16 duties and responsibilities which shall be documented by the agency
17 using a form prescribed for such purpose by the Office of Management
18 and Enterprise Services.

19 E. The provisions of subsection A and subsection B of this
20 section shall not be applicable to the executive director or other
21 chief executive officers of an agency. Such positions shall be
22 subject to rules established by the agency on pay, bonuses and
23 raises pursuant to subsection C of this section.

1 F. The provisions of subsection A and subsection B of this
2 section shall not be applicable to job positions or categories
3 requiring advanced degrees or licensing or accreditation including,
4 but not limited to, medical doctors, certified public accountants,
5 and professional engineers. Such positions shall not be subject to
6 the provisions of subsection A or subsection B of this section.
7 Such positions shall be subject to rules established by their
8 employing agency on pay, bonus and raises pursuant to subsection C
9 of this section.

10 G. The provisions of subsection A and subsection B of this
11 section shall not be applicable to wholly non-appropriated state
12 agencies or their employees. Wholly non-appropriated state agencies
13 shall not be subject to the rulemaking provisions of this section.
14 Such agencies shall remain subject to the pay movement mechanisms
15 listed in subsection B of Section 840-2.17 of Title 74 of the
16 Oklahoma Statutes. Salary increases or bonuses exceeding ten
17 percent (10%) received by any employee of an agency governed by this
18 subsection shall be documented by the agency on a form prescribed
19 for such purpose by the Office of Management and Enterprise
20 Services. At least one copy shall be retained by the agency
21 providing the salary increase or bonus and one copy shall be
22 retained by the Office of Management and Enterprise Services.

23 H. The provisions of subsection A and subsection B of this
24 section shall not be applicable to the employees of institutions

1 within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education, employees of
2 any career technology district or to employees of any common school
3 district. The provisions of subsection A and subsection B of this
4 section shall be applicable to employees of the Oklahoma State
5 Regents for Higher Education.

6 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

7 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
8 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
9 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
10 be in full force from and after its passage and approval."

11 Passed the House of Representatives the 7th day of May, 2026.

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14 Presiding Officer of the House of
15 Representatives

16 Passed the Senate the ____ day of _____, 2026.

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19 Presiding Officer of the Senate

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1 ENGROSSED SENATE
2 BILL NO. 650

By: Paxton of the Senate

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6 An Act relating to public utilities; defining term;
7 requiring the governing body of a public utility to
8 adopt a plan for components of maintenance and
9 operation of public utilities; providing for contents
10 of plan; specifying process for notice; allowing for
11 public utilities to be in compliance upon approval of
12 plan; authorizing certain state agencies to verify
13 certain provisions of plan; preventing certain
14 recovery of damages under certain circumstances;
15 amending 51 O.S. 2021, Sections 152, as last amended
16 by Section 111, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024, 154, and
17 155, as amended by Section 21, Chapter 228, O.S.L.
18 2022 (51 O.S. Supp. 2024, Sections 152 and 155),
19 which relate to The Governmental Tort Claims Act;
20 defining term; increasing award amounts for certain
21 claims; specifying certain accidents and occurrences;
22 providing for the process and amounts awarded under
23 certain circumstances; expanding exemptions for
24 liability by the state or political subdivisions;
updating statutory references and language; making
language gender neutral; providing for codification;
and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 37-235 of Title 11, unless there
is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

1 A. As used in this section, "public utility" means a
2 municipally owned utility or other publicly owned utility providing
3 sewage services through a sanitary sewer system.

4 B. The governing body of the public utility shall adopt a plan
5 that includes, but is not limited to, the following:

6 1. Mapping and recordkeeping of a sanitary sewer system for
7 maintenance and operation of the system;

8 2. A policy of inspections, cleaning, and root control of sewer
9 lines that contains the following elements:

10 a. an inspection program of sewer lines to determine
11 whether sewage flows are clear, moderately occluded,
12 or severely occluded,

13 b. a program of routine maintenance of sewer lines, and

14 c. a treatment program for sewer lines identified as
15 having blockages due to root infiltration, of which
16 the public utility has notice, with root control
17 through either mechanical or chemical treatments;

18 3. A policy of responding to calls for sanitary sewer overflows
19 (SSOs) to clear municipal sewer mains, flush with water and
20 deodorize the land upon which SSO has occurred, and remove SSO
21 debris from land upon which SSO has occurred;

22 4. Adoption of a "Fats, Oils, and Grease (FOG) Ordinance" that
23 makes unlawful the improper introduction of fats, oils, or grease
24 from nonresidential entities that are connected to the sanitary

1 sewer system and incorporating pre-treatment regulations adopted by
2 the Department of Environmental Quality for such entities. Public
3 utilities shall periodically notify sanitary sewer system
4 participants and dischargers of the restrictions within this
5 paragraph;

6 5. Adoption of an ordinance requiring new construction or
7 remodels of existing buildings to be connected to the sanitary sewer
8 system, including the installation of a backflow prevention device
9 on the private service line connecting the structure to the sanitary
10 sewer main line;

11 6. Adoption of a policy that will notify private residential
12 property owners who are connected to the sanitary sewer system of
13 the option to provide additional personal protection through
14 installation of a backflow prevention system on the private service
15 line connecting the property to the sanitary sewer main line. At
16 the discretion of the governing body of the public utility, after
17 considering available funding, private residential property owners
18 connected to the sewer system may be offered public assistance with
19 installation and inspection of backflow prevention devices;

20 7. Adoption of a funding availability model that identifies:

21 a. the total revenue from ratepayers that can reasonably
22 be expected over a fiscal year,

23 b. other funding sources from municipal revenues that can
24 reasonably be expected to be contributed to the

1 sanitary sewer system operations, maintenance, or
2 capital improvements,

3 c. external sources of funding from local, state,
4 federal, or tribal entities that could be available
5 for sanitary sewer system operations, maintenance, or
6 capital improvements, and

7 d. bonding capacities, whether revenue bonds or general
8 obligation bonds, that could be available for sanitary
9 sewer system operations, maintenance, or capital
10 improvements.

11 Funding availability models shall be reviewed at least every five
12 (5) years to include a rate study recommending reasonable rates for
13 those connected to the sanitary sewer system; and

14 8. Adoption of a five-year capital improvement plan that
15 considers dedication of funding available to:

16 a. repair or replace sanitary sewer lines that have been
17 identified as severely occluded,

18 b. repair or replace municipal sanitary sewer lift
19 stations necessary for the continued operation of the
20 system, and

21 c. access or purchase equipment for operation of the
22 municipal sanitary sewer system serving the citizens
23 of the municipality that are connected to the
24 municipal sanitary sewer system.

1 C. Notification as described in paragraphs 4 and 6 of
2 subsection B of this section shall be satisfied by annual
3 publication in a newspaper of general circulation within the service
4 area of the public utility, publication on the public utility
5 sponsored website, or annual inserts in ratepayer monthly utility
6 bills. Nothing in this subsection shall be construed to prohibit a
7 public utility from making multiple notifications to ratepayers in
8 the one-year period.

9 D. Public utilities that implement policies prescribed in
10 subsection B of this section shall be considered in compliance with
11 the provisions of this section.

12 E. The Oklahoma Water Resources Board and other state agencies
13 that provide funding to public utilities for water and wastewater
14 improvements shall ensure that any ranking structure for approval of
15 applications for funding considers the sustainability efforts of
16 systems that adopted the plans identified in this statute.

17 F. There shall be no right of recovery for personal injury from
18 a sanitary sewer overflow, provided that the utility charged with
19 operation of the sanitary sewer system is working to maintain its
20 sanitary sewer system in accordance with the guidance and criteria
21 promulgated by the governing body pursuant to subsection B of this
22 section and any criteria or guidelines promulgated by a governmental
23 entity under an interlocal cooperative agreement pursuant to Section
24 1001 et seq. of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes, as such

1 components are determined by the governing body to be fiscally
2 achievable considering available revenue streams to the public
3 utility to fund the same. While those municipalities qualifying for
4 relief under this section shall be exempt from personal injury
5 damage claims of annoyance and inconvenience associated with a
6 sanitary sewer overflow that alleges a nuisance-based cause of
7 action, nothing herein shall otherwise prohibit a right of recovery
8 for property damages associated with a sanitary sewer overflow in
9 accordance with The Governmental Tort Claims Act.

10 SECTION 5. AMENDATORY 51 O.S. 2021, Section 152, as last
11 amended by Section 111, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (51 O.S. Supp.
12 2024, Section 152), is amended to read as follows:

13 Section 152. As used in The Governmental Tort Claims Act:

14 1. "Action" means a proceeding in a court of competent
15 jurisdiction by which one party brings a suit against another;

16 2. "Agency" means any board, commission, committee, department
17 or other instrumentality or entity designated to act in behalf of
18 the state or a political subdivision;

19 3. "Charitable health care provider" means a person who is
20 licensed, certified, or otherwise authorized by the laws of this
21 state to administer health care in the ordinary course of business
22 or the practice of a profession and who provides care to a medically
23 indigent person, as defined in paragraph 9 of this section, with no
24 expectation of or acceptance of compensation of any kind;

1 4. "Claim" means any written demand presented by a claimant or
2 the claimant's authorized representative in accordance with ~~the~~ The
3 Governmental Tort Claims Act to recover money from the state or
4 political subdivision as compensation for an act or omission of a
5 political subdivision or the state or an employee;

6 5. "Claimant" means the person or the person's authorized
7 representative who files notice of a claim in accordance with The
8 Governmental Tort Claims Act. Only the following persons and no
9 others may be claimants:

- 10 a. any person holding an interest in real or personal
11 property which suffers a loss, provided that the claim
12 of the person shall be aggregated with claims of all
13 other persons holding an interest in the property and
14 the claims of all other persons which are derivative
15 of the loss, and that multiple claimants shall be
16 considered a single claimant,
- 17 b. the individual actually involved in the accident or
18 occurrence who suffers a loss, provided that the
19 individual shall aggregate in the claim the losses of
20 all other persons which are derivative of the loss, or
- 21 c. in the case of death, an administrator, special
22 administrator or a personal representative who shall
23 aggregate in the claim all losses of all persons which
24 are derivative of the death;

1 6. "Community health care provider" means:

2 a. a health care provider who volunteers services at a
3 community health center that has been deemed by the
4 U.S. Department of Health and Human Services as a
5 federally qualified health center as defined by 42
6 U.S.C., Section 1396d(1)(2)(B),

7 b. a health provider who provides services to an
8 organization that has been deemed a federally
9 qualified look-alike community health center, and

10 c. a health care provider who provides services to a
11 community health center that has made application to
12 the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services for
13 approval and deeming as a federally qualified look-
14 alike community health center in compliance with
15 federal application guidance, and has received
16 comments from the U.S. Department of Health and Human
17 Services as to the status of such application with the
18 established intent of resubmitting a modified
19 application, or, if denied, a new application, no
20 later than six (6) months from the date of the
21 official notification from the U.S. Department of
22 Health and Human Services requiring resubmission of a
23 new application;

1 7. "Employee" means any person who is authorized to act in
2 behalf of a political subdivision or the state whether that person
3 is acting on a permanent or temporary basis, with or without being
4 compensated or on a full-time or part-time basis.

5 a. Employee also includes:

6 (1) all elected or appointed officers, members of
7 governing bodies and other persons designated to
8 act for an agency or political subdivision, but
9 the term does not mean a person or other legal
10 entity while acting in the capacity of an
11 independent contractor or an employee of an
12 independent contractor,

13 (2) from September 1, 1991, through June 30, 1996,
14 licensed physicians, licensed osteopathic
15 physicians and certified nurse-midwives providing
16 prenatal, delivery or infant care services to
17 State Department of Health clients pursuant to a
18 contract entered into with the State Department
19 of Health in accordance with paragraph 3 of
20 subsection ~~B~~ C of Section 1-106 of Title 63 of
21 the Oklahoma Statutes but only insofar as
22 services authorized by and in conformity with the
23 terms of the contract and the requirements of
24

1 Section 1-233 of Title 63 of the Oklahoma
2 Statutes, and

3 (3) any volunteer, full-time or part-time firefighter
4 when performing duties for a fire department
5 provided for in subparagraph j of paragraph ~~11~~ 12
6 of this section.

7 b. For the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act,
8 the following are employees of this state, regardless
9 of the place in this state where duties as employees
10 are performed:

- 11 (1) physicians acting in an administrative capacity,
12 (2) resident physicians and resident interns
13 participating in a graduate medical education
14 program of the University of Oklahoma Health
15 Sciences Center, the Oklahoma State University
16 College of Osteopathic Medicine ~~of Oklahoma State~~
17 ~~University~~, or the Department of Mental Health
18 and Substance Abuse Services,
19 (3) faculty members and staff of the University of
20 Oklahoma Health Sciences Center and the Oklahoma
21 State University College of Osteopathic Medicine
22 ~~of Oklahoma State University~~, while engaged in
23 teaching duties,

1 (4) physicians who practice medicine or act in an
2 administrative capacity as an employee of an
3 agency of the State of Oklahoma,

4 (5) physicians who provide medical care to inmates
5 pursuant to a contract with the Department of
6 Corrections,

7 (6) any person who is licensed to practice medicine
8 pursuant to Title 59 of the Oklahoma Statutes,
9 who is under an administrative professional
10 services contract with the Oklahoma Health Care
11 Authority under the auspices of the Oklahoma
12 Health Care Authority Chief Medical Officer, and
13 who is limited to performing administrative
14 duties such as professional guidance for medical
15 reviews, reimbursement rates, service
16 utilization, health care delivery and benefit
17 design for the Oklahoma Health Care Authority,
18 only while acting within the scope of such
19 contract,

20 (7) licensed medical professionals under contract
21 with city, county, or state entities who provide
22 medical care to inmates or detainees in the
23 custody or control of law enforcement agencies,
24

1 (8) licensed mental health professionals as defined
2 in Sections 1-103 and 5-502 of Title 43A of the
3 Oklahoma Statutes, who are conducting initial
4 examinations of individuals for the purpose of
5 determining whether an individual meets the
6 criteria for emergency detention as part of a
7 contract with the Department of Mental Health and
8 Substance Abuse Services, and

9 (9) licensed mental health professionals as defined
10 in Sections 1-103 and 5-502 of Title 43A of the
11 Oklahoma Statutes, who are providing mental
12 health or substance abuse treatment services
13 under a professional services contract with the
14 Department of Mental Health and Substance Abuse
15 Services and are providing such treatment
16 services at a state-operated facility.

17 Physician faculty members and physician staff of the
18 University of Oklahoma Health Sciences Center and the
19 Oklahoma State University College of Osteopathic
20 ~~Medicine of Oklahoma State University~~ not acting in an
21 administrative capacity or engaged in teaching duties
22 are not employees or agents of the state.

23 c. For the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act,
24 employee shall include independent contractors and

1 employees of independent contractors while actively
2 engaged in the transport of individuals in need of
3 initial assessment, emergency detention, or protective
4 custody as authorized by Section 1-110 of Title 43A of
5 the Oklahoma Statutes.

6 d. Except as provided in subparagraph b of this
7 paragraph, in no event shall the state be held liable
8 for the tortious conduct of any physician, resident
9 physician or intern while practicing medicine or
10 providing medical treatment to patients.

11 e. For purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act,
12 members of the state military forces on state active
13 duty orders or on Title 32 active duty orders are
14 employees of this state, regardless of the place,
15 within or outside this state, where their duties as
16 employees are performed;

17 8. "Loss" means death or injury to the body or rights of a
18 person or damage to real or personal property or rights therein;

19 9. "Medically indigent" means a person requiring medically
20 necessary hospital or other health care services for the person or
21 the dependents of the person who has no public or private third-
22 party coverage, and whose personal resources are insufficient to
23 provide for needed health care;

1 10. "Municipality" means any incorporated city or town, and all
2 institutions, agencies or instrumentalities of a municipality;

3 11. "Occurrence" means a loss arising out of an accident or
4 event or a continuous or repeated exposure to substantially the same
5 general harmful conditions. All losses arising out of an accident
6 or event or a continuous or repeated exposure to substantially the
7 same general harmful conditions shall be deemed to have arisen out
8 of one occurrence;

9 12. "Political subdivision" means:

- 10 a. a municipality,
- 11 b. a school district, including, but not limited to, a
12 technology center school district established pursuant
13 to Section 4410, 4411, 4420 or 4420.1 of Title 70 of
14 the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 15 c. a county,
- 16 d. a public trust where the sole beneficiary or
17 beneficiaries are a city, town, school district or
18 county. For purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims
19 Act, a public trust shall include:

- 20 (1) a municipal hospital created pursuant to Sections
21 30-101 through 30-109 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma
22 Statutes, a county hospital created pursuant to
23 Sections 781 through 796 of Title 19 of the
24 Oklahoma Statutes, or is created pursuant to a

1 joint agreement between such governing
2 authorities, that is operated for the public
3 benefit by a public trust created pursuant to
4 Sections 176 through 180.4 of Title 60 of the
5 Oklahoma Statutes and managed by a governing
6 board appointed or elected by the municipality,
7 county, or both, who exercises control of the
8 hospital, subject to the approval of the
9 governing body of the municipality, county, or
10 both,

11 (2) a public trust created pursuant to Sections 176
12 through 180.4 of Title 60 of the Oklahoma
13 Statutes after January 1, 2009, the primary
14 purpose of which is to own, manage, or operate a
15 public acute care hospital in this state that
16 serves as a teaching hospital for a medical
17 residency program provided by a college of
18 osteopathic medicine and provides care to
19 indigent persons, and

20 (3) a corporation in which all of the capital stock
21 is owned, or a limited liability company in which
22 all of the member interest is owned, by a public
23 trust,
24

- 1 e. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
2 only, a housing authority created pursuant to the
3 provisions of the Oklahoma Housing Authorities Act,
- 4 f. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
5 only, corporations organized not for profit pursuant
6 to the provisions of the Oklahoma General Corporation
7 Act for the primary purpose of developing and
8 providing rural water supply and sewage disposal
9 facilities to serve rural residents,
- 10 g. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
11 only, districts formed pursuant to the Rural Water,
12 Sewer, Gas and Solid Waste Management Districts Act,
- 13 h. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
14 only, master conservancy districts formed pursuant to
15 the Conservancy Act of Oklahoma,
- 16 i. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
17 only, a fire protection district created pursuant to
18 the provisions of Section 901.1 et seq. of Title 19 of
19 the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 20 j. for the purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act
21 only, a benevolent or charitable corporate volunteer
22 or full-time fire department for an unincorporated
23 area created pursuant to the provisions of Section 592
24 et seq. of Title 18 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

- 1 k. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
2 an ~~Emergency Services Provider~~ emergency services
3 provider rendering services ~~within the boundaries of a~~
4 ~~Supplemental Emergency Services District~~ pursuant to
5 an existing contract between the ~~Emergency Services~~
6 ~~Provider~~ emergency services provider and the State
7 Department of Health. Provided, however, that the
8 acquisition of commercial liability insurance covering
9 the activities of such ~~Emergency Services Provider~~
10 emergency services provider performed within this
11 state shall not operate as a waiver of any of the
12 limitations, immunities or defenses provided for
13 political subdivisions pursuant to the terms of The
14 Governmental Tort Claims Act,
- 15 l. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
16 a conservation district created pursuant to the
17 provisions of the Conservation District Act,
- 18 m. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act,
19 districts formed pursuant to the Oklahoma Irrigation
20 District Act,
- 21 n. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
22 any community action agency established pursuant to
23 Sections 5035 through ~~5040~~ 5040.1 of Title 74 of the
24 Oklahoma Statutes,

- 1 o. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
2 any organization that is designated as a youth
3 services agency, pursuant to Section 2-7-306 of Title
4 10A of the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 5 p. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
6 any judge presiding over a drug court, as defined by
7 Section 471.1 of Title 22 of the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 8 q. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
9 any child-placing agency licensed by this state to
10 place children in foster family homes,
- 11 r. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
12 a circuit engineering district created pursuant to
13 Section 687.1 of Title 69 of the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 14 s. for purposes of ~~the~~ The Governmental Tort Claims Act
15 only, a substate planning district, regional council
16 of government or other entity created pursuant to
17 Section 1001 et seq. of Title 74 of the Oklahoma
18 Statutes, and
- 19 t. for purposes of The Governmental Tort Claims Act only,
20 a regional transportation authority created pursuant
21 to Section 1370.7 of Title 68 of the Oklahoma Statutes
22 including its contract operator and any railroad
23 operating in interstate commerce that sells a property
24 interest or provides services to a regional

1 transportation authority or allows the authority to
2 use the property or tracks of the railroad for the
3 provision of public passenger rail service to the
4 extent claims against the contract operator or
5 railroad arise out of or are related to or in
6 connection with such property interest, services or
7 operation of the public passenger rail service.

8 Provided, the acquisition of commercial liability
9 insurance to cover the activities of the regional
10 transportation authority, contract operator or
11 railroad shall not operate as a waiver of any
12 liabilities, immunities or defenses provided pursuant
13 to the provisions of ~~the~~ The Governmental Tort Claims
14 Act,

15 and all their institutions, instrumentalities or agencies;

16 ~~12.~~ 13. "Scope of employment" means performance by an employee
17 acting in good faith within the duties of the employee's office or
18 employment or of tasks lawfully assigned by a competent authority
19 including the operation or use of an agency vehicle or equipment
20 with actual or implied consent of the supervisor of the employee,
21 but shall not include corruption or fraud;

22 ~~13.~~ 14. "State" means the State of Oklahoma or any office,
23 department, agency, authority, commission, board, institution,
24 hospital, college, university, public trust created pursuant to

1 Title 60 of the Oklahoma Statutes of which the State of Oklahoma is
2 the beneficiary, or other instrumentality thereof;

3 ~~14.~~ 15. "State active duty" shall be defined in accordance with
4 Section 801 of Title 44 of the Oklahoma Statutes;

5 ~~15.~~ 16. "State military forces" shall be defined in accordance
6 with Section 801 of Title 44 of the Oklahoma Statutes;

7 ~~16.~~ 17. "Title 32 active duty" shall be defined in accordance
8 with Section 801 of Title 44 of the Oklahoma Statutes; and

9 ~~17.~~ 18. "Tort" means a legal wrong, independent of contract,
10 involving violation of a duty imposed by general law, statute, the
11 Constitution of the State of Oklahoma, or otherwise, resulting in a
12 loss to any person, association or corporation as the proximate
13 result of an act or omission of a political subdivision or the state
14 or an employee acting within the scope of employment; provided,
15 however, a tort shall not include a claim for inverse condemnation.

16 SECTION 6. AMENDATORY 51 O.S. 2021, Section 154, is
17 amended to read as follows:

18 Section 154. A. The total liability of the state and its
19 political subdivisions on claims within the scope of The
20 Governmental Tort Claims Act, arising out of an accident or
21 occurrence happening after October 1, 1985, Section 151 et seq. of
22 this title, shall not exceed:

23 1. ~~Twenty-five Thousand Dollars (\$25,000.00)~~ Thirty-five
24 Thousand Dollars (\$35,000.00) for any claim or to any claimant who

1 has more than one claim for loss of property, including related
2 consequential damages, arising out of a single act, accident, or
3 occurrence;

4 2. For physical injury from a municipal overflow or backup,
5 Five Thousand Dollars (\$5,000.00) per individual person occupying
6 the structure at the time of the occurrence not to exceed an
7 aggregate damage amount of Twenty Thousand Dollars (\$20,000.00) per
8 occurrence regardless of the number of persons affected by the
9 occurrence;

10 3. For nuisance, annoyance, or inconvenience damages from a
11 municipal overflow or backup, Five Thousand Dollars (\$5,000.00) per
12 individual person occupying the structure at the time of the
13 occurrence not to exceed an aggregate damage amount of Twenty
14 Thousand Dollars (\$20,000.00) per occurrence regardless of the
15 number of persons affected by the occurrence;

16 4. Except as otherwise provided in this paragraph, One Hundred
17 Twenty-five Thousand Dollars (\$125,000.00) to any claimant for a
18 claim for any other loss arising out of a single act, accident, or
19 occurrence. The limit of liability for the state or any city or
20 county with a population of three hundred thousand (300,000) or more
21 according to the latest Federal Decennial Census, or a political
22 subdivision as defined in subparagraph s of paragraph ~~11~~ 12 of
23 Section 152 of this title, shall not exceed One Hundred Seventy-five
24 Thousand Dollars (\$175,000.00). Except however, the limits of ~~the~~

1 liability for the University Hospitals and ~~State Mental Health~~
2 ~~Hospitals~~ state mental health hospitals operated by the Department
3 of Mental Health and Substance Abuse Services for claims arising
4 from medical negligence shall be Two Hundred Thousand Dollars
5 (\$200,000.00). For claims arising from medical negligence by any
6 licensed physician, osteopathic physician or certified nurse-midwife
7 rendering prenatal, delivery or infant care services from September
8 1, 1991, through June 30, 1996, pursuant to a contract authorized by
9 subsection ~~B~~ C of Section 1-106 of Title 63 of the Oklahoma Statutes
10 and in conformity with the requirements of Section 1-233 of Title 63
11 of the Oklahoma Statutes, the limits of ~~the~~ liability shall be Two
12 Hundred Thousand Dollars (\$200,000.00); or

13 ~~3.~~ 5. One Million Dollars (\$1,000,000.00) for any number of
14 claims for indemnification pursuant to Section 162 of this title
15 arising out of a single occurrence or accident.

16 B. 1. Beginning on May 28, 2003, claims shall be allowed for
17 wrongful criminal felony conviction resulting in imprisonment if the
18 claimant has received a full pardon on the basis of a written
19 finding by the Governor of actual innocence for the crime for which
20 the claimant was sentenced or has been granted judicial relief
21 absolving the claimant of guilt on the basis of actual innocence of
22 the crime for which the claimant was sentenced. The Governor or the
23 court shall specifically state, in the pardon or order, the evidence
24 or basis on which the finding of actual innocence is based.

1 2. As used in paragraph 1 of this subsection, for a claimant to
2 recover based on "actual innocence", the individual must meet the
3 following criteria:

4 a. the individual was charged, by indictment or
5 information, with the commission of a public offense
6 classified as a felony,

7 b. the individual did not plead guilty to the offense
8 charged, or to any lesser included offense, but was
9 convicted of the offense,

10 c. the individual was sentenced to incarceration for a
11 term of imprisonment as a result of the conviction,

12 d. the individual was imprisoned solely on the basis of
13 the conviction for the offense, and

14 e. (1) in the case of a pardon, a determination was made
15 by either the Pardon and Parole Board or the
16 Governor that the offense for which the
17 individual was convicted, sentenced and
18 imprisoned, including any lesser offenses, was
19 not committed by the individual, or

20 (2) in the case of judicial relief, a court of
21 competent jurisdiction found by clear and
22 convincing evidence that the offense for which
23 the individual was convicted, sentenced and
24 imprisoned, including any lesser included

1 offenses, was not committed by the individual and
2 issued an order vacating, dismissing or reversing
3 the conviction and sentence and providing that no
4 further proceedings can be or will be held
5 against the individual on any facts and
6 circumstances alleged in the proceedings which
7 had resulted in the conviction.

8 3. A claimant shall not be entitled to compensation for any
9 part of a sentence in prison during which the claimant was also
10 serving a concurrent sentence for a crime not covered by this
11 subsection.

12 4. The total liability of the state and its political
13 subdivisions on any claim within the scope of The Governmental Tort
14 Claims Act arising out of wrongful criminal felony conviction
15 resulting in imprisonment shall not exceed One Hundred Seventy-five
16 Thousand Dollars (\$175,000.00).

17 5. The provisions of this subsection shall apply to convictions
18 occurring on or before May 28, 2003, as well as convictions
19 occurring after May 28, 2003. If a court of competent jurisdiction
20 finds that retroactive application of this subsection is
21 unconstitutional, the prospective application of this subsection
22 shall remain valid.

1 C. No award for damages in an action or any claim against the
2 state or a political subdivision shall include punitive or exemplary
3 damages.

4 D. When the amount awarded to or settled upon multiple
5 claimants exceeds the limitations of this section, any party may
6 apply to the district court which has jurisdiction of the cause to
7 apportion to each claimant the claimant's proper share of the total
8 amount as limited herein. The share apportioned to each claimant
9 shall be in the proportion that the ratio of the award or settlement
10 made to ~~him~~ each claimant bears to the aggregate awards and
11 settlements for all claims against the state or its political
12 subdivisions arising out of the occurrence. When the amount of the
13 aggregate losses presented by a single claimant exceeds the limits
14 ~~of paragraph 1 or 2~~ of subsection A of this section, each person
15 suffering a loss shall be entitled to that person's proportionate
16 share.

17 E. The total liability of resident physicians and interns while
18 participating in a graduate medical education program of the
19 University of Oklahoma College of Medicine, its affiliated
20 institutions and the Oklahoma State University College of
21 Osteopathic Medicine ~~and Surgery~~ shall not exceed One Hundred
22 Thousand Dollars (\$100,000.00).

23 F. The state or a political subdivision may petition the court
24 that all parties and actions arising out of a single accident or

1 occurrence shall be joined as provided by law, and upon order of the
2 court the proceedings upon good cause shown shall be continued for a
3 reasonable time or until such joinder has been completed. The state
4 or political subdivision shall be allowed to interplead in any
5 action which may impose on it any duty or liability pursuant to The
6 Governmental Tort Claims Act.

7 G. The liability of the state or political subdivision under
8 The Governmental Tort Claims Act shall be several from that of any
9 other person or entity, and the state or political subdivision shall
10 only be liable for that percentage of total damages that corresponds
11 to its percentage of total negligence. Nothing in this section
12 shall be construed as increasing the liability limits imposed on the
13 state or political subdivision under The Governmental Tort Claims
14 Act.

15 SECTION 7. AMENDATORY 51 O.S. 2021, Section 155, as
16 amended by Section 21, Chapter 228, O.S.L. 2022 (51 O.S. Supp. 2024,
17 Section 155), is amended to read as follows:

18 Section 155. The state or a political subdivision shall not be
19 liable if a loss or claim results from:

- 20 1. Legislative functions;
- 21 2. Judicial, quasi-judicial, or prosecutorial functions, other
22 than claims for wrongful criminal felony conviction resulting in
23 imprisonment provided for in Section 154 of this title;
- 24 3. Execution or enforcement of the lawful orders of any court;

1 4. Adoption or enforcement of or failure to adopt or enforce a
2 law, whether valid or invalid, including, but not limited to, any
3 statute, charter provision, ordinance, resolution, rule, regulation
4 or written policy;

5 5. Performance of or the failure to exercise or perform any act
6 or service which is in the discretion of the state or political
7 subdivision or its employees;

8 6. Civil disobedience, riot, insurrection or rebellion or the
9 failure to provide, or the method of providing, police, law
10 enforcement or fire protection;

11 7. Any claim based on the theory of attractive nuisance;

12 8. Snow or ice conditions or temporary or natural conditions on
13 any public way or other public place due to weather conditions,
14 unless the condition is affirmatively caused by the negligent act of
15 the state or a political subdivision;

16 9. Entry upon any property where that entry is expressly or
17 implied authorized by law;

18 10. Natural conditions of property of the state or political
19 subdivision;

20 11. Assessment or collection of taxes or special assessments,
21 license or registration fees, or other fees or charges imposed by
22 law;

23 12. Licensing powers or functions including, but not limited
24 to, the issuance, denial, suspension or revocation of or failure or

1 refusal to issue, deny, suspend or revoke any permit, license,
2 certificate, approval, order or similar authority;

3 13. Inspection powers or functions, including failure to make
4 an inspection, review or approval, or making an inadequate or
5 negligent inspection, review or approval of any property, real or
6 personal, to determine whether the property complies with or
7 violates any law or contains a hazard to health or safety, or fails
8 to conform to a recognized standard;

9 14. Any loss to any person covered by any workers' compensation
10 act or any employer's liability act;

11 15. Absence, condition, location or malfunction of any traffic
12 or road sign, signal or warning device unless the absence,
13 condition, location or malfunction is not corrected by the state or
14 political subdivision responsible within a reasonable time after
15 actual or constructive notice or the removal or destruction of such
16 signs, signals or warning devices by third parties, action of
17 weather elements or as a result of traffic collision except on
18 failure of the state or political subdivision to correct the same
19 within a reasonable time after actual or constructive notice.

20 Nothing herein shall give rise to liability arising from the failure
21 of the state or any political subdivision to initially place any of
22 the above signs, signals or warning devices. The signs, signals and
23 warning devices referred to herein are those used in connection with
24 hazards normally connected with the use of roadways or public ways

1 and do not apply to the duty to warn of special defects such as
2 excavations or roadway obstructions;

3 16. Any claim which is limited or barred by any other law;

4 17. Misrepresentation, if unintentional;

5 18. An act or omission of an independent contractor or
6 consultant or his or her employees, agents, subcontractors or
7 suppliers or of a person other than an employee of the state or
8 political subdivision at the time the act or omission occurred;

9 19. Theft by a third person of money in the custody of an
10 employee unless the loss was sustained because of the negligence or
11 wrongful act or omission of the employee;

12 20. Participation in or practice for any interscholastic or
13 other athletic contest sponsored or conducted by or on the property
14 of the state or a political subdivision;

15 21. Participation in any activity approved by a local board of
16 education and held within a building or on the grounds of the school
17 district served by that local board of education before or after
18 normal school hours or on weekends;

19 22. Use of indoor or outdoor school property and facilities
20 made available for public recreation before or after normal school
21 hours or on weekends or school vacations, except those claims
22 resulting from willful and wanton acts of negligence. For purposes
23 of this paragraph:
24

1 a. "public" includes, but is not limited to, students
2 during nonschool hours and school staff when not
3 working as employees of the school, and

4 b. "recreation" means any indoor or outdoor physical
5 activity, either organized or unorganized, undertaken
6 for exercise, relaxation, diversion, sport or
7 pleasure, and that is not otherwise covered by
8 paragraph 20 or 21 of this section;

9 23. Any court-ordered, Department of Corrections or county
10 approved work release program; provided, however, this provision
11 shall not apply to claims from individuals not in the custody of the
12 Department of Corrections based on accidents involving motor
13 vehicles owned or operated by the Department of Corrections;

14 24. The activities of the state military forces when on state
15 active duty orders or on Title 32 active duty orders;

16 25. Provision, equipping, operation or maintenance of any
17 prison, jail or correctional facility, or injuries resulting from
18 the parole or escape of a prisoner or injuries by a prisoner to any
19 other prisoner; provided, however, this provision shall not apply to
20 claims from individuals not in the custody of the Department of
21 Corrections based on accidents involving motor vehicles owned or
22 operated by the Department of Corrections;

23 26. Provision, equipping, operation or maintenance of any
24 juvenile detention facility, or injuries resulting from the escape

1 of a juvenile detainee, or injuries by a juvenile detainee to any
2 other juvenile detainee;

3 27. Any claim or action based on the theory of manufacturer's
4 products liability or breach of warranty, either expressed or
5 implied;

6 28. Any claim or action based on the theory of indemnification
7 or subrogation; provided, however, a political subdivision as
8 defined in subparagraph s of paragraph ~~11~~ 12 of Section 152 of this
9 title may enter into a contract with a contract operator or any
10 railroad operating in interstate commerce that sells a property
11 interest or provides services to a regional transportation
12 authority, or allows the regional transportation authority to use
13 the railroad's property or tracks for the provision of public
14 passenger rail service, providing for the allocation of financial
15 responsibility, indemnification, or the procurement of insurance for
16 the parties for all types of claims or damages, provided that funds
17 have been appropriated to cover the resulting contractual obligation
18 at the time the contract is executed. The acquisition of commercial
19 liability insurance to cover the activities of the regional
20 transportation authority, contract operator or railroad shall not
21 operate as a waiver of any of the liabilities, immunities or
22 defenses provided for political subdivisions pursuant to the
23 provisions of The Governmental Tort Claims Act. A contract entered
24 into under this paragraph shall not affect rights of employees under

1 the Federal ~~Employers~~ Employers' Liability Act or the ~~Federal~~
2 Railway Labor Act;

3 29. Any claim based upon an act or omission of an employee in
4 the placement of children;

5 30. Acts or omissions done in conformance with then current
6 recognized standards;

7 31. Maintenance of the state highway system or any portion
8 thereof unless the claimant presents evidence which establishes
9 either that the state failed to warn of the unsafe condition or that
10 the loss would not have occurred but for a negligent affirmative act
11 of the state;

12 32. Any confirmation of the existence or nonexistence of any
13 effective financing statement on file in the ~~office~~ Office of the
14 Secretary of State made in good faith by an employee of the ~~office~~
15 Office of the Secretary of State as required by the provisions of
16 Section 1-9-320.6 of Title 12A of the Oklahoma Statutes;

17 33. Any court-ordered community sentence;

18 34. Remedial action and any subsequent related maintenance of
19 property pursuant to and in compliance with an authorized
20 environmental remediation program, order, or requirement of a
21 federal or state environmental agency;

22 35. The use of necessary and reasonable force by a school
23 district employee to control and discipline a student during the
24

1 time the student is in attendance or in transit to and from the
2 school, or any other function authorized by the school district;

3 36. Actions taken in good faith by a school district employee
4 for the out-of-school suspension of a student pursuant to applicable
5 Oklahoma Statutes; ~~or~~

6 37. Use of a public facility opened to the general public
7 during an emergency;

8 38. Flooding, backups, or stoppages of storm sewers or sanitary
9 sewers that are caused by unordinary rainfall events, considering
10 duration and intensity of the rainfall events, that result in flows
11 that exceed the design capacity of the sewer system;

12 39. Sanitary sewer overflows that have occurred on lines within
13 the sanitary sewer system where no report of a blockage, backup, or
14 overflow has been made to the political subdivision or utility
15 operator within the preceding three (3) years; or

16 40. A sanitary sewer overflow occurring on private property,
17 provided that the utility operator is in compliance with Section 1
18 of this act. This paragraph shall not apply to claims for loss of
19 property.

20 SECTION 8. This act shall become effective November 1, 2025.
21
22
23
24

1 Passed the Senate the 25th day of March, 2025.

2
3 _____
4 Presiding Officer of the Senate

5 Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
6 2025.

7
8 _____
9 Presiding Officer of the House
10 of Representatives